Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Hugh Bidder

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Hugh Bidder

International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison

Hugh insists everything is priceless, right up until he names a price. Hugh is the person wealthy collectors call when they want something no one else seems able to find.

• Buys art for **Elon Mosaic**. **Elon** likes to pretend he found it himself. Hugh doesn't mind.

• **Penny Pincher** asks Hugh for auction previews, then argues with every estimate. He hates dealing with her.

• Keeps offering to represent **Vincent Van Faux**. **Vincent** wants to discuss the commission before the paintings.

ACTING TIPS

Smooth, suave, sociable, opportunistic, impossible to embarrass. Treat every conversation like a deal that has not yet revealed itself. You're the coolest guy in the room and you know it.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Hugh Bidder. Everything has a price. My charming conversation is the only exception, and even that is negotiable.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Hugh Bidder

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

His respectable firm is the life he built after being dismissed as a small-time hustler. Public exposure would strip away that invented security.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Hugh Bidder

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A seat with a cold metallic skeleton keeps its secret underneath.*

2 *A little door hides shelves and, tonight, a secret.*

3 *A book beginning with creation has a secret between its pages.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Hugh Bidder

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant wanted a refund on the Star Bowl and a public admission that its certificate was false. My firm supplied it. I changed our file instead of admitting we'd been fooled. Elon began worrying about his other purchases; Saul was available to help him worry. I offered a settlement. Grant preferred an audience. Some of you knew me before I had a respectable office. He liked reminding me.

IF MURDERER

Grant wanted a refund on the Star Bowl and a public admission that its certificate was false. My firm supplied it. I changed our file instead of admitting we'd been fooled. Elon began worrying about his other purchases; Saul was available to help him worry. My settlement wasn't enough. Grant wanted the admission tonight. Some of you knew me before I had a respectable office. He meant to send me back there.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Hugh Bidder

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I withheld the seller's correspondence from the auction handouts. It covered the bowl and the Velvet Widow purchase I arranged. The bottle sale required original contents. Grant called the liquid inert in his loan description. I had both; the display writers got the comfortable version. A second bad purchase beside the first would have been quite an evening for Saul. I was not in a charitable mood.

IF MURDERER

I kept the seller's correspondence out of the auction handouts. Bowl and bottle, both purchases. Grant had demanded one refund already. I brought the retained file to his private place to settle it quietly. His glass was there; he wasn't. I took my file away again. Saul, you can call that evasive. I wasn't having a dealer dispute performed for your collectors. A client says refund softly enough and somehow everybody hears it.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Original contents. That was the seller's condition. I forwarded the complete attachment to intake before the gala. Grant supplied the inert description afterward; I repeated it to the donors. Saul, I know you want me to say it slowly enough to sound like a confession. I have clients in this room. The refund demand was withdrawn, and I intend to hold his estate to that. Elon can request his purchase files through my solicitor. I am not opening them on this table for your entertainment.

IF MURDERER

> Before the loan, the original-contents condition was canceled. The seller was to empty the bottle and replace the liquid with an inert substitute. Grant's declaration described that delivery. Intake had the earlier attachment. I altered the bowl file; I have admitted that. The bottle was a separate purchase with changed instructions. Saul, please save your condolences. I know what your expression means.

STOP

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BALLOT

Hugh Bidder

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The seller attachment was unaltered when I sent it to intake before the gala. I still sold the bowl under a false certificate, changed our file, and repeated Grant's harmless-liquid claim without resolving it. He deserved the refund. Elon, you deserve to see your purchase files. I dislike the man Saul thinks I am. I have given him a very good case tonight.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The original-contents condition was never canceled. I had arranged the purchase; I knew what had been required. During the closed preview I took poison from that bottle. Later, while the private glass was unattended, I used it. The harmless-substitution story was the cover I gave you. The executed sale, seller's statement and residue findings contradicted it. His refund demand on the bowl would have finished my firm. I could have faced the bad sale and the file alteration. Saul can have the clients. Elon can have every file. I wanted so badly to remain the respectable man behind that desk that I have made him impossible to remember.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.